ALLAMAHUL BAYAN SERIES · BOOK 50

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

My First Burmese Alphabet
ကျွန်ုပ်၏ ပထမဆုံး မြန်မာအက္ခရာ

A Coloring Book to Learn, Trace & Say the 44 Burmese Letters with English Phonetics



Written by Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza

Illustrations: AI-assisted, edited by the author

Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah

مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

REVIEW DRAFT — not for publication

REVIEW DRAFT — DO NOT PUBLISH YET. The letter names, sound guides, words, transliterations and phrases in this book were drafted with AI and have not yet been checked by a native speaker. After review, set `draft=False` in the language file and rebuild; this notice then disappears.

My First Burmese Alphabet — ကျွန်ုပ်၏ ပထမဆုံး မြန်မာအက္ခရာ
Allamahul Bayan Series, Book 50

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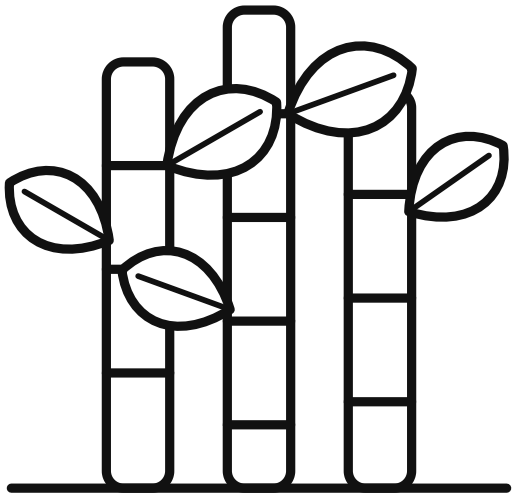
Published by **Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah** (مكتبة كنوز الآخرة),
An imprint of the Kunujul Akhirah Charitable Trust, Bangladesh.
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First edition, 2026.

Illustrations: line art created with AI assistance and reviewed by the author. In keeping with the publisher's guidelines, the pictures show objects, plants and nature only — no people or animals.

Fonts: Noto Sans Myanmar, Padauk, Fredoka, Nunito, Amiri and Dancing Script, all under the SIL Open Font License. **Map data:** Natural Earth (public domain).

A note of respect: this book contains verses of the Noble Qur'an (pages 4–5). Please handle it with care and keep it in a clean place.



This book belongs to
ဤစာအုပ်ပိုင်ရှင်

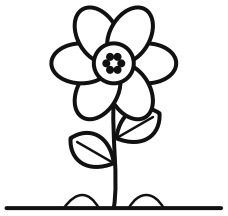
_____

I started learning Burmese on

_____







ABOUT THIS SERIES

The Allamahul Bayan Series

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

ʿallamahul-bayān — "He taught him clear expression"

الرَّحْمَٰنُ ﴿١﴾ عَلَّمَ الْقُرْآنَ ﴿٢﴾ خَلَقَ الْإِنسَانَ ﴿٣﴾ عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ ﴿٤﴾

Ar-Raḥmān. ʿAllamal-Qurʾān. Khalaqal-insān. ʿAllamahul-bayān.

"The Most Merciful. He taught the Qur'an. He created the human being. He taught him clear expression (al-bayān)."

Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4[1]

Surah Ar-Raḥmān — the chapter of *The Most Merciful* — opens by naming some of Allah's greatest gifts to us. First, **He taught the Qur'an**. Then, **He created the human being**. And then, **He taught him al-bayān**.

What does *al-bayān* mean? It comes from an Arabic root that means *to make something clear*. Al-bayān is the gift of speech and understanding: being able to put what is in our hearts and minds into words, to explain, to listen, and to be understood. Animals make sounds, but only people were taught to speak, read and write in languages. Scholars of tafsīr explain that this gift is what lets us learn, teach and pass on guidance — including the Qur'an itself.

So every time a child says a new word, sounds out a letter, or writes their first line in a new language, they are using a gift that Allah Himself says He taught. That is the heart of this series: **learning languages as a way of thanking Allah for al-bayān.**

Languages and colours: two signs of Allah

وَمِنْ آيَاتِهِ خَلْقُ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ وَاخْتِلَافُ أَلْسِنَتِكُمْ وَأَلْوَانِكُمْ ۚ إِنَّ فِي ذَٰلِكَ لَآيَاتٍ لِّلْعَالِمِينَ ﴿٢٢﴾

Wa min āyātihī khalqus-samāwāti wal-arḍi wakh-tilāfu alsinatikum wa alwānikum. Inna fī dhālika la-āyātil-lil-ʿālimīn.

"And among His signs is the creation of the heavens and the earth, and the variety of your languages and your colours. Surely in that are signs for those who know."

Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22[1]

In Surah Ar-Rūm, Allah tells us that the **many languages** of people and their **many colours** are among His signs. A coloring book that teaches a language brings both of these signs together in a child's hands: they meet a new language, and they fill its letters with colour.

وَجَعَلْنَاكُمْ شُعُوبًا وَقَبَائِلَ لِتَعَارَفُوا

Wa jaʿalnākum shuʿūban wa qabāʾila li-taʿārafū.

"...and We made you into peoples and tribes so that you may get to know one another."

Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13 (part)[1]

Allah made us into many peoples *so that we may get to know one another*. Learning even a few letters of someone's language is a beautiful first step towards knowing them.

How each book in the series works

Every book introduces one language **through English**:

- where the language is spoken, with a map to color;
- every letter of its alphabet, with its name in the language itself *and* in English letters;
- simple English sound guides, so a parent who has never heard the language can still help;
- a word and picture for every letter, to color, trace and say out loud.

Book 50 is Burmese. More languages from around the world are in the series, in shā' Allāh.

FOR PARENTS AND TEACHERS

How to use this book

Begin with **Bismillah**, and go **little and often**: one letter a day is plenty for a young child. For each letter:

1. **Say it.** Read the letter's name and its sound guide together. Say it three times.
2. **Color it.** Color the big letter any way your child likes.
3. **Trace it.** Trace the dotted letters with a pencil, then try one alone in the empty boxes.
4. **Meet the word.** Say the word, color the picture, and talk about it in English.

Marker tip: every coloring page has a blank back, so colours cannot spoil the next activity. Slip a sheet of scrap paper behind the page you are coloring anyway — it keeps the next page clean.

Reading the English sound guides

- **Doubled vowels are long:** *aa* as in "father", *ee* as in "see", *oo* as in "moon".
- **h after a letter** (*kh*, *hs*, *ht*, *ph*) means "add a puff of breath". Without the h (*k*, *s*, *t*, *p*) say it with **no** puff, as in "skip", "stop", "spin". *ht* is a 't' with a puff — never the English "th".
- **j** in words like *ka-jee* and *jan* is how the letters ကျ ⟦ကျ⟧ sound: like 'j' or 'ch'.
- **Tones:** the English letters show the sounds, not the tunes. The tones are best learned by listening.

Three ways to see every sound

Each letter page shows the sound three ways: the letter's **Burmese name** written in Burmese (native phonetics), the **same name in English letters**, and an **English sound guide**. The box marked *Burmese phonetics* shows the letter joined to the vowel sign ◌ာ (က + ◌ာ = ကာ *kaa*) and what its traditional name means. On the vowel pages it shows the vowel sign and its Burmese name.

The pronunciation guides are simplified for young learners and follow the standard Burmese of Yangon and Mandalay.

MEET THE LANGUAGE

Hello, Burmese! မြန်မာ

myan-maa — the Burmese word for the language

Who speaks it?
More than **40 million people** speak Burmese: about 33 million as their first language, and millions more as a second language.[3]

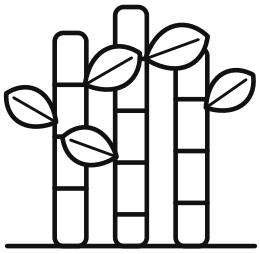
Where?
In **Myanmar** (also called Burma), along the great **Ayeyarwady River**, and by Burmese families around the world.

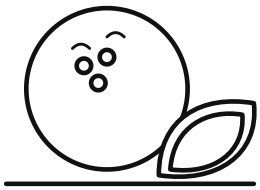
How is it written?
In the **Myanmar script**, from **left to right**. Spaces go between phrases, not between every word.

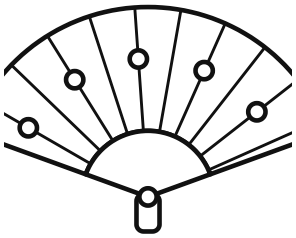
How many letters?
This book teaches **44**: the **33 consonants** and the **11 main vowel signs**, each shown on the letter အ.

Round letters
Burmese letters are made of **circles** and curves, because they were once scratched onto **palm leaves**, where straight lines would tear.

Did you know?
The Ayeyarwady River runs the whole length of Myanmar, more than **2,000 km**, from the mountains in the north to the sea.







THE WHOLE ALPHABET

The Burmese Alphabet အက္ခရာ

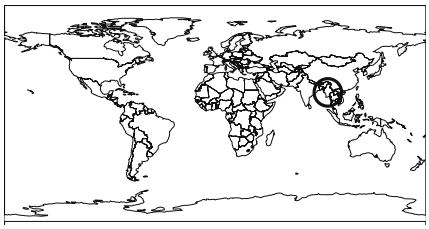
33 consonants — ဗျည်း

က *ka-jee*	ခ *kha-gway*	ဂ *ga-ngeh*	ဃ *ga-jee*	င *nga*	စ *sa-loun*	ဆ *hsa-lein*
ဇ *za-gweh*	ဈ *za-myin-zweh*	ည *nya-jee*	ဋ *ta-ta-lin-jeik*	ဌ *hta-wun-beh*	ဍ *da-yin-gauk*	ဎ *da-yay-hmout*
ဏ *na-jee*	တ *ta-wun-boo*	ထ *hta-hsin-htoo*	ဒ *da-dway*	ဓ *da-auk-chaik*	န *na-ngeh*	ပ *pa-zauk*
ဖ *pha-oo-htouk*	ဗ *ba-htet-chaik*	ဘ *ba-goun*	မ *ma*	ယ *ya-pet-let*	ရ *ya-gauk*	လ *la*
ဝ *wa*	သ *tha*	ဟ *ha*	ဠ *la-jee*	အ *a*		

11 vowels — သရ

အာ *aa*	အိ *i*	အီ *ee*	အု *u*	အူ *oo*	အေ *ay*
အဲ *eh*	အော *aw*	အော် *aw*	အံ *an*	အို့ *o*	

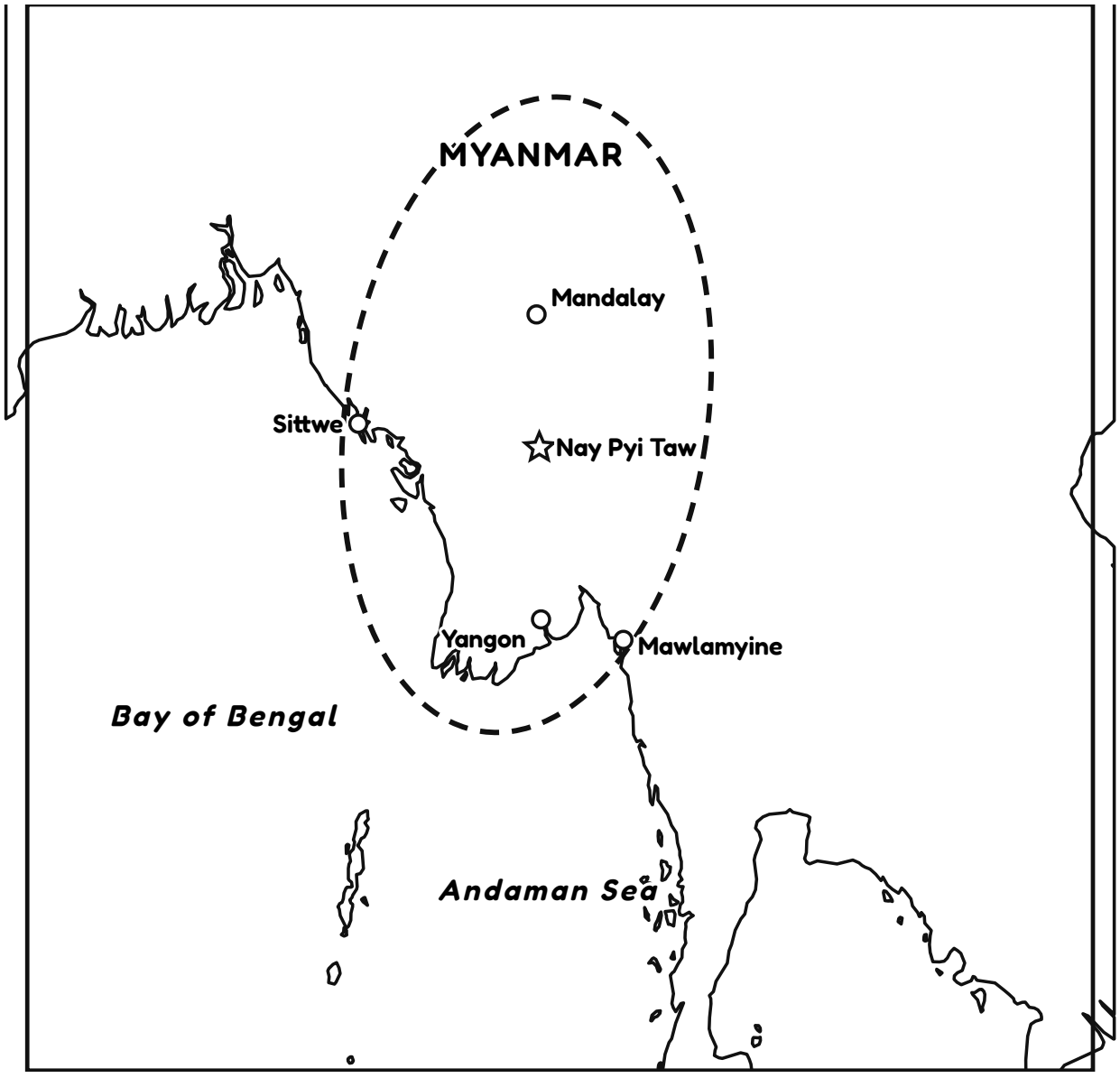
Read the alphabet row by row — the same order as in this book.



The circle shows Myanmar on the world map.

COLOR THE MAP

Where is Burmese spoken?



Color it: the middle of Myanmar, where most Burmese speakers live (inside the dashed line), **yellow** · the rest of the land **green** · the seas **blue**. **Find it:** Mandalay, Nay Pyi Taw ★ and Yangon. Draw the long **Ayeyarwady River** flowing south to the sea!

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PART 1

The Consonants ဗျည်း

byee — the 33 consonants

Burmese children first learn the **33 consonants**, in rows of five, in the same order as this book: က ခ ဂ ဃ င *ka, kha, ga, ga, nga…*

Every letter has a name

Some letters sound the same, so each one has a **name** that tells them apart: ကကြီး *ka-jee* “big ka”, ဂငယ် *ga-ngeh* “small ga”, စလုံး *sa-loun* “round sa”. Say the names as you color!

The hidden vowel

Every consonant carries a short **‘a’**: က is *ka*, မ is *ma*. Add a vowel sign to change it:

က + ◌ာ = ကာ *(kaa)*

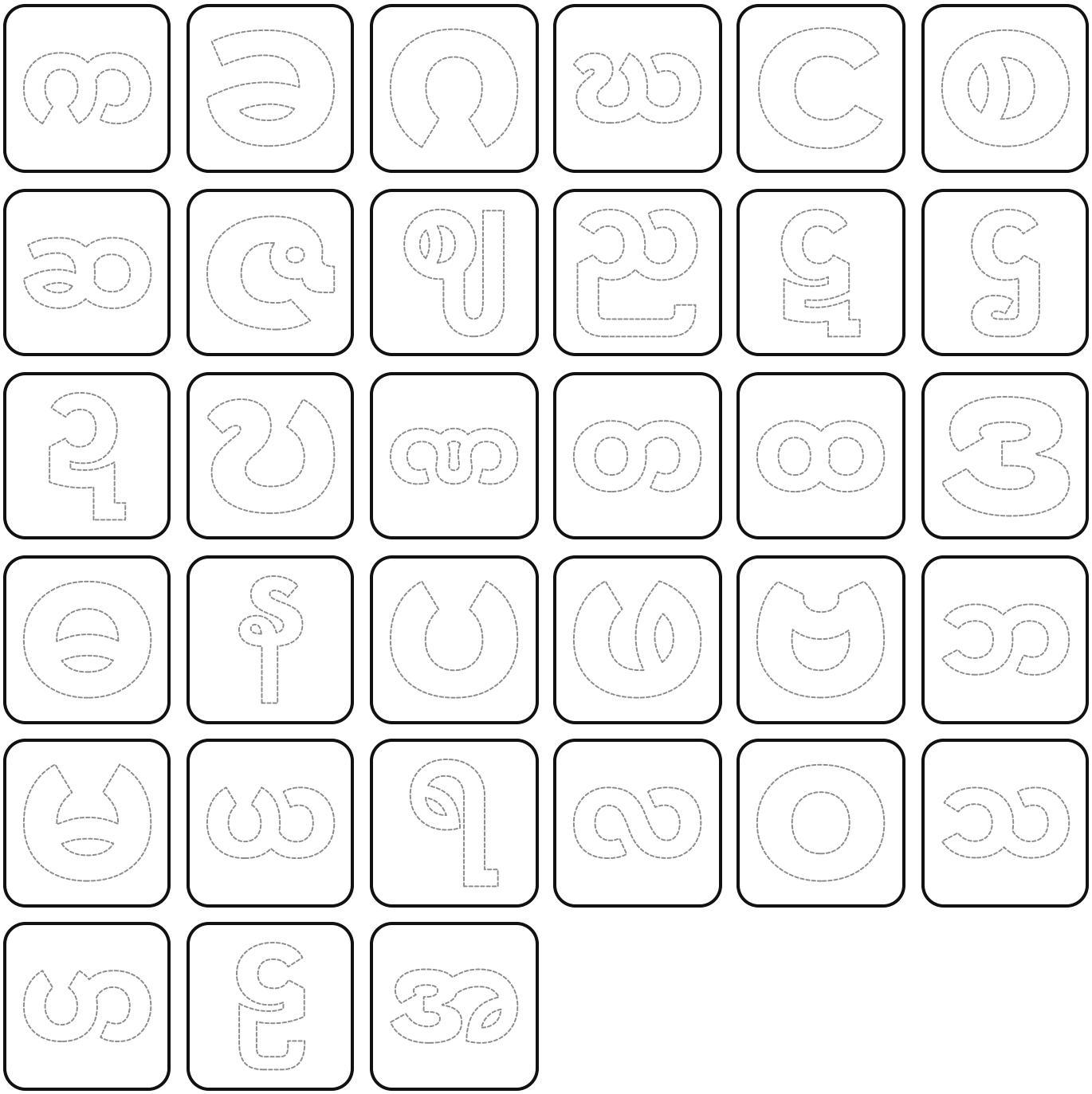
Round letters

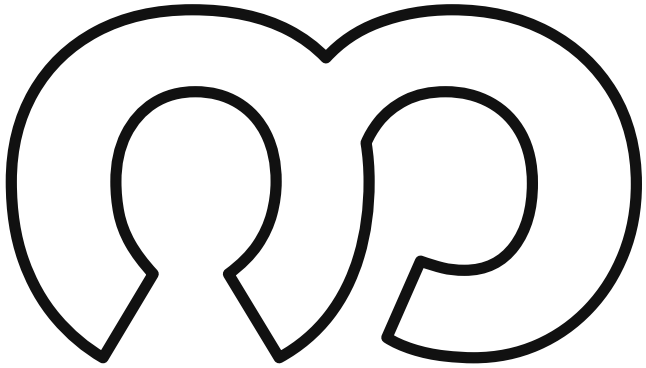
Long ago, Burmese was written on dried **palm leaves** with a sharp metal pen. Long straight lines would split the leaf, so the letters grew round — almost every letter is built from **circles**!

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the consonants ဗျည်း

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.





NAME · နာမည်

ကကြီး

ka-jee

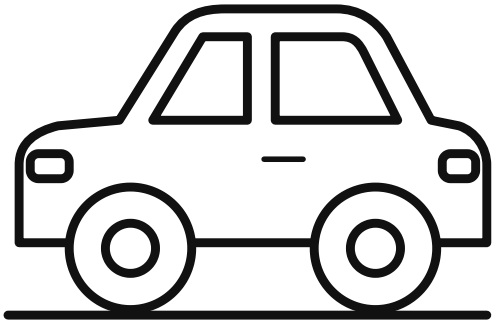
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'k' as in "skip" (no puff of air)

BURMESE PHONETICS · WITH THE SIGN ာ

က + ာ = ကာ *(kaa)*

Its name ကကြီး means "big ka".



က IS FOR

ကား

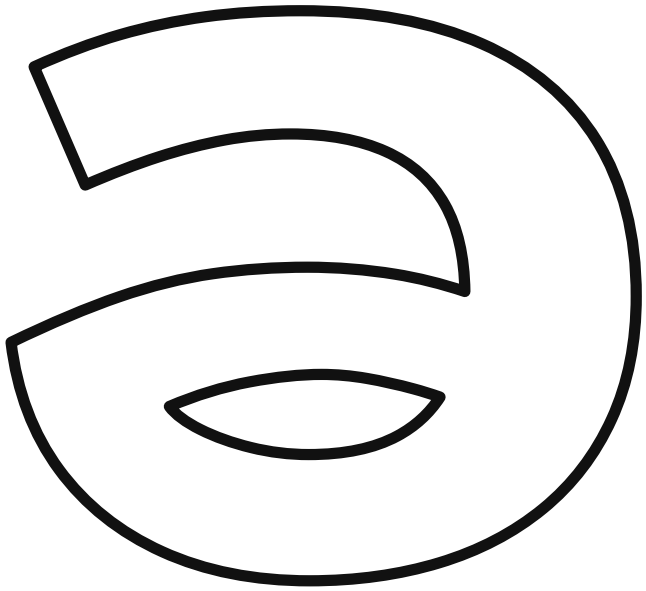
kaa

car

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ရေးပါ

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NAME · နာမည်

ခဂွဲး

kha-gway

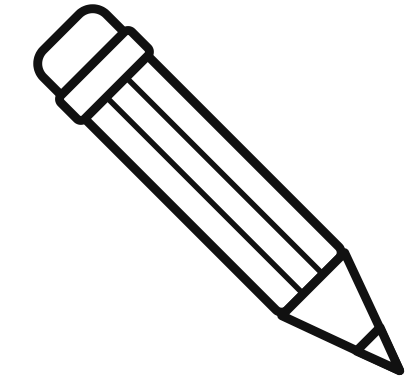
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'k' with a puff of air, as in "kite"

BURMESE PHONETICS · WITH THE SIGN ◌ာ

ခ + ◌ါ = ခါ *(khaa)*

Round letters like this one take the **tall** sign ◌ါ, so they are not mixed up with another letter.



ခ IS FOR

ခဲတံ

kheh-dan

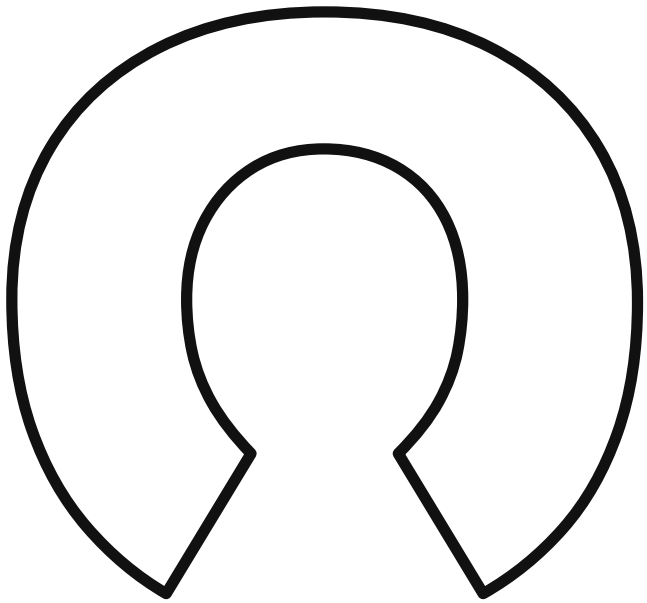
pencil

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ရေးပါ

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NAME · နာမည်

ဂငယ်

ga-ngeh

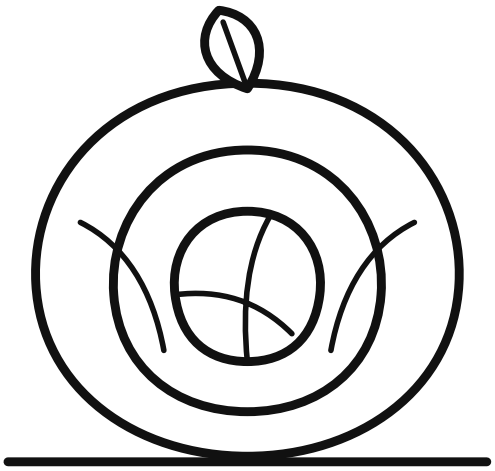
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'g' as in "go"

BURMESE PHONETICS · WITH THE SIGN ◌ာ

ဂ + ◌ါ = ဂါ *(gaa)*

Its name ဂငယ် means "small ga". Round letters like this one take the **tall** sign ◌ါ, so they are not mixed up with another letter.



ဂ IS FOR

ဂေါ်ဖီ

gaw-bee

cabbage

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ရေးပါ

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ယ

NAME · နာမည်

ယကြီး

ga-jee

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

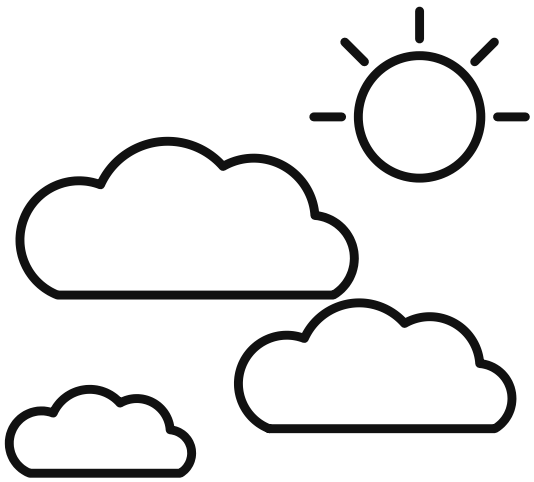
‘g’ as in “go” — a rare letter

BURMESE PHONETICS · WITH THE SIGN ာ

ယ + ာ = ယာ *(gaa)*

Its name ယကြီး means “big ga”.

ယ is a rare letter, used in a few words that came from the old Pali language — find it in မိုးမေယ!



ယ IS FOR

မိုးမေယ

moe-may-ga

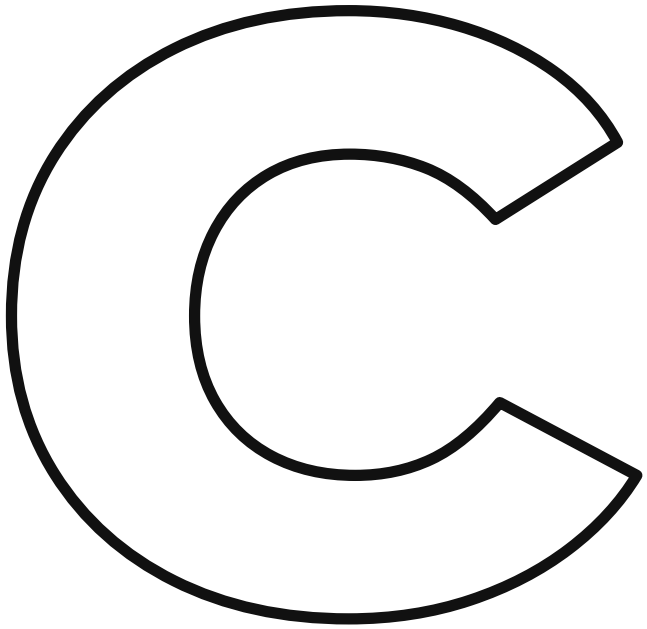
the sky and the clouds

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ရေးပါ

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NAME · နာမည်

င

nga

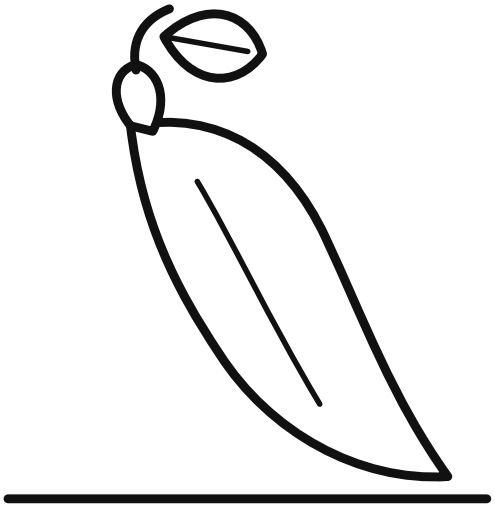
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'ng' as in "sing" — Burmese words can start with it!

BURMESE PHONETICS · WITH THE SIGN ◌ာ

င + ◌ါ = ငါ *(ngaa)*

Round letters like this one take the **tall** sign ◌ါ, so they are not mixed up with another letter.



င IS FOR

ငရုတ်သီး

nga-youk-thee

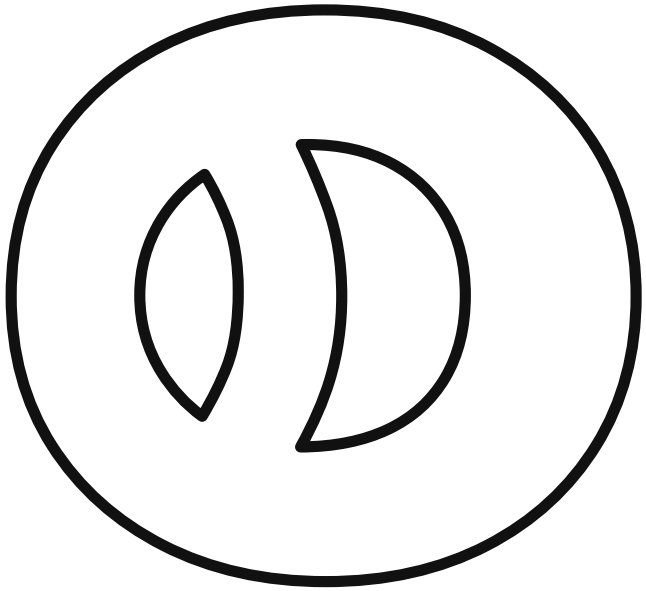
chilli pepper

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ရေးပါ

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NAME · နာမည်

စလုံး

sa-loun

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

's' as in "sun" (no puff of air)

BURMESE PHONETICS · WITH THE SIGN ◌ာ

စ + ◌ာ = စာ *(saa)*

Its name စလုံး means "round sa".



စ IS FOR

စာအုပ်

sa-ouk

book

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ရေးပါ

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ဆ

NAME · နာမည်

ဆလိမ်

hsa-lein

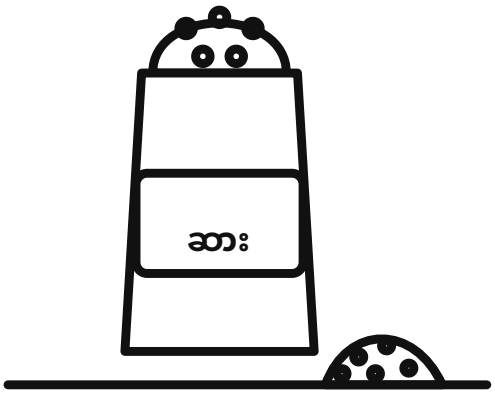
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

's' with a puff of air

BURMESE PHONETICS · WITH THE SIGN ာ

ဆ + ာ = ဆာ *(hsaa)*

Its name ဆလိမ် means "twisted sa".



ဆ IS FOR

ဆား

hsaa

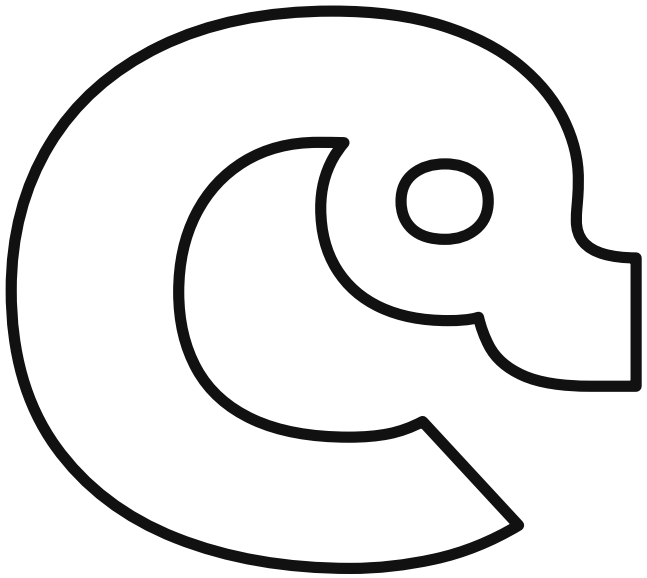
salt

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ရေးပါ

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NAME · နာမည်

ဇကွဲ

za-gweh

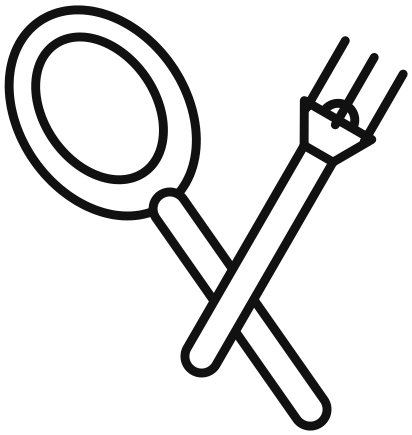
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'z' as in "zoo"

BURMESE PHONETICS · WITH THE SIGN ◌ာ

ဇ + ◌ာ = ဇာ *(zaa)*

Its name ဇကွဲ means "split za".



ဇ IS FOR

ဇူးန်း

zoon

spoon

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ရေးပါ

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ဈ

NAME · နာမည်

ဈမျဉ်းဆွဲ

za-myin-zweh

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'z' as in "zoo"

BURMESE PHONETICS · WITH THE SIGN ◌ာ

ဈ + ◌ာ = ဈာ *(zaa)*

Its name ဈမျဉ်းဆွဲ means "za with a line drawn on it".



ဈ IS FOR

ဈေး

zay

market

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ရေးပါ

ဈ ဈ ဈ ဈ

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ည

NAME · နာမည်

ညကြီး

nya-jee

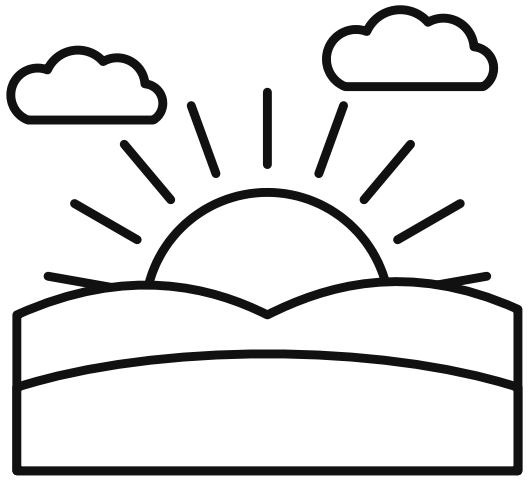
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'ny' as in "canyon"

BURMESE PHONETICS · WITH THE SIGN ◌ာ

ည + ◌ာ = ညာ *(nyaa)*

Its name ညကြီး means "big nya".



ည IS FOR

ညနေ

nya-nay

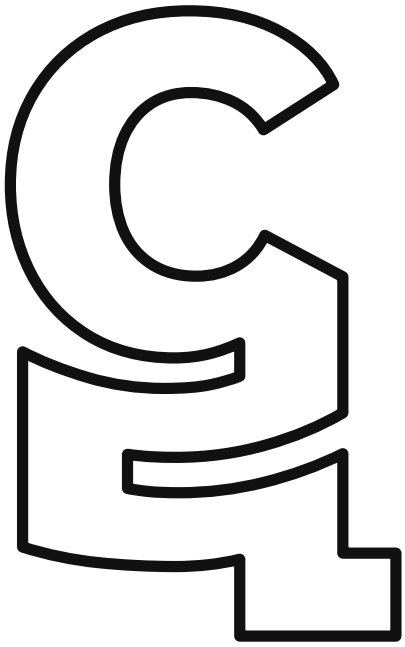
evening

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ရေးပါ

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NAME · နာမည်

ဋဌန်လျင်းချိတ်

ta-ta-lin-jeik

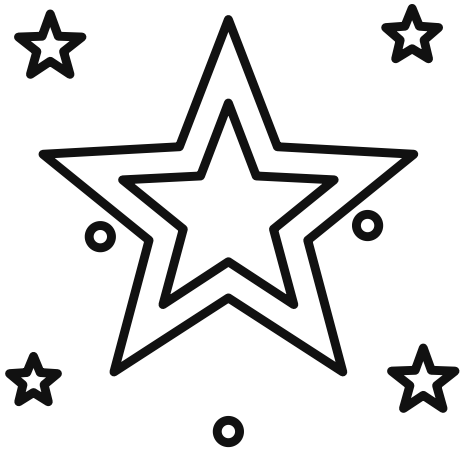
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

't' as in "stop" — a rare letter

BURMESE PHONETICS · WITH THE SIGN ◌ာ

ဋ္ဌ + ◌ာ = ဋ္ဌာ *(taa)*

ဋ္ဌ is a rare letter, used in a few words that came from the old Pali language — find it in ကုဋ္ဌေ!



ဋ္ဌ IS FOR

ကုဋ္ဌေ

ku-day

ten million — a very big number!

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ရေးပါ

ဋ္ဌ ဋ္ဌ ဋ္ဌ ဋ္ဌ

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ဌ

NAME · နာမည်

ဌဝမ်းဘဲ

hta-wun-beh

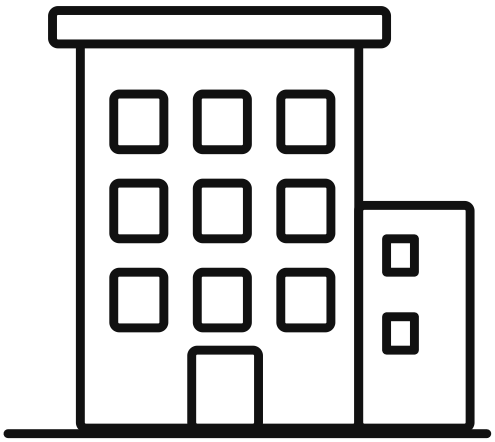
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

't' with a puff of air — a rare letter

BURMESE PHONETICS · WITH THE SIGN ◌ာ

ဌ + ◌ာ = ဏာ *(htaa)*

ဌ is a rare letter, used in a few words that came from the old Pali language.



ဌ IS FOR

ဌာန

hta-na

office, department

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ရေးပါ

ဌ ဌ ဌ ဌ

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ဍ

NAME · နာမည်

ဍရင်ကောက်

da-yin-gauk

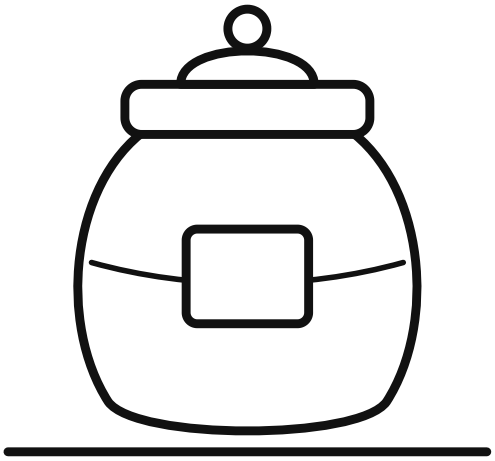
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'd' as in "day" — a rare letter

BURMESE PHONETICS · WITH THE SIGN ◌ာ

ဍ + ◌ာ = ဍာ *(daa)*

ဍ is a rare letter, used in a few words that came from the old Pali language — it hides under ဏ in ဘဏ္ဍာ!



ဍ IS FOR

ဘဏ္ဍာ

ban-daa

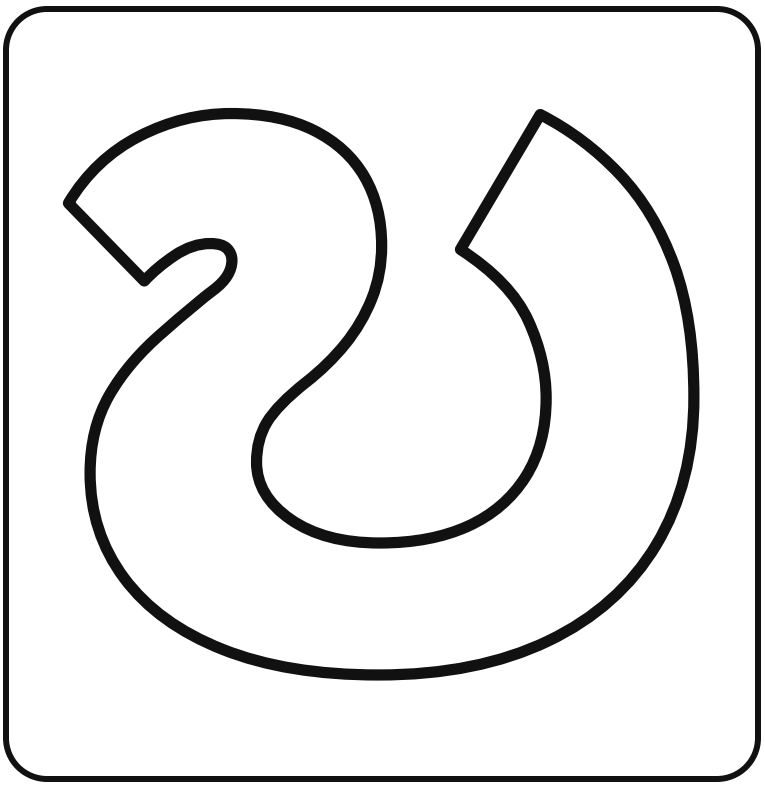
treasure, savings

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ရေးပါ

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NAME · နာမည်

ပရေးမှတ်

da-yay-hmout

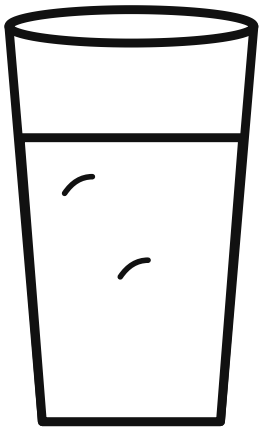
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'd' as in "day" — the rarest letter of all

BURMESE PHONETICS · WITH THE SIGN ◌ာ

ပ + ◌ာ = ပာ *(daa)*

ပ is almost never used in words today, so we learn it by its name. Can you find ရေ *yay* (water) inside its name?



ပ IS FOR

ပရေးမှတ်

da-yay-hmout

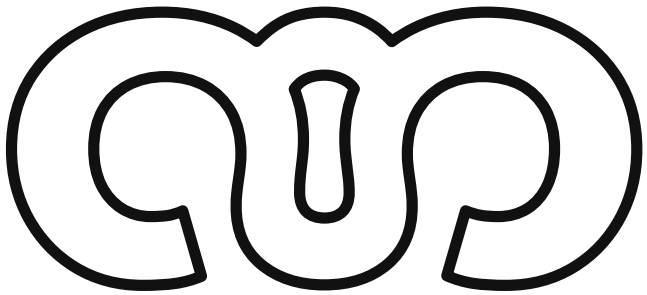
the letter's own name

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ရေးပါ

ပ ပ ပ ပ

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NAME · နာမည်

ဏကြီး

na-jee

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

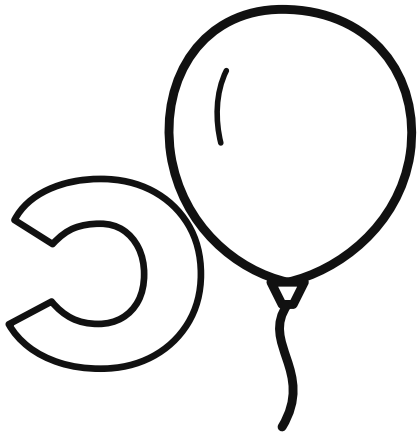
'n' as in "net" — almost never at the start of a word

BURMESE PHONETICS · WITH THE SIGN ◌ာ

ဏ + ◌ာ = ဏာ *(naa)*

Its name ဏကြီး means "big na".

Find ဏ in the middle of ဂဏန်း!



ဏ IS FOR

ဂဏန်း

ga-nan

numbers

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ရေးပါ

ဏာ ဏာ ဏာ ဏာ

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တ

NAME · နာမည်

တဝမ်းပူ

ta-wun-boo

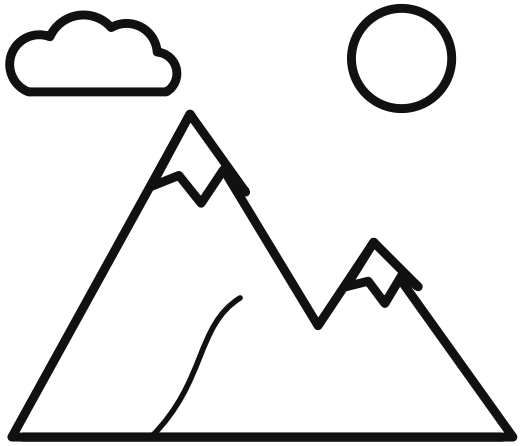
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘t’ as in “stop” (no puff of air)

BURMESE PHONETICS · WITH THE SIGN ာ

တ + ာ = တာ *(taa)*

Its name တဝမ်းပူ means “pot-bellied ta”.



တ IS FOR

တောင်

taung

mountain

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ရေးပါ

တ တ တ တ

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ထ

NAME · နာမည်

ထဆင်ထိုး

hta-hsin-htoo

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

't' with a puff of air, as in "top"

BURMESE PHONETICS · WITH THE SIGN ◌ာ

ထ + ◌ာ = ထာ *(htaa)*



ထ IS FOR

ထီး

htee

umbrella

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ရေးပါ

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ဒ

NAME · နာမည်

ဒဒွေး

da-dway

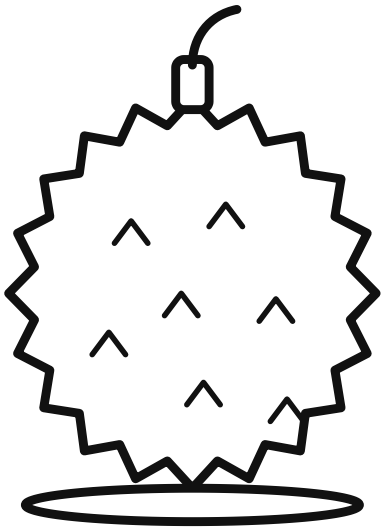
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'd' as in "day"

BURMESE PHONETICS · WITH THE SIGN ◌ာ

ဒ + ◌ါ = ဒါ *(daa)*

Round letters like this one take the **tall** sign ◌ါ, so they are not mixed up with another letter.



ဒ IS FOR

ဒူးရင်း

doo-yin

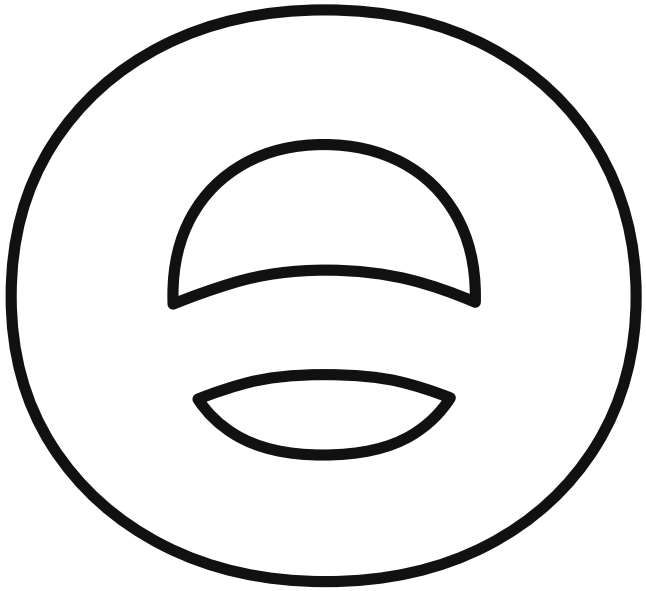
durian (a spiky fruit)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ရေးပါ

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NAME · နာမည်

ဓအောက်ခြိုက်

da-auk-chaik

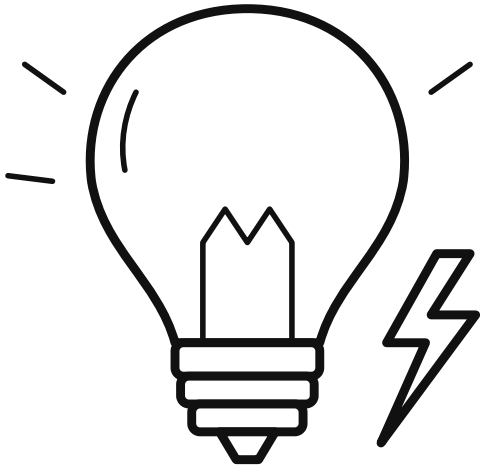
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'd' as in "day"

BURMESE PHONETICS · WITH THE SIGN ◌ာ

ဓ + ◌ာ = ဓာ *(daa)*

Its name ဓအောက်ခြိုက် means "da with a dip below".



ဓ IS FOR

ဓာတ်မီးသီး

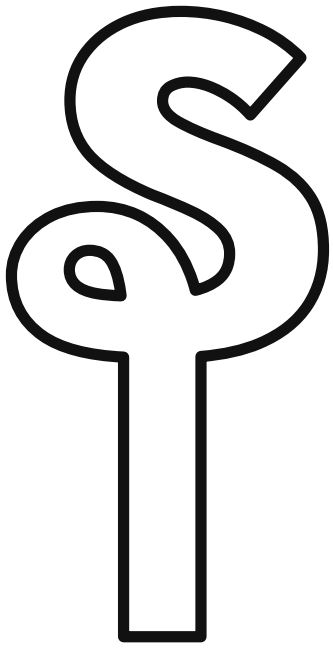
dat-mee-thee

light bulb

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ရေးပါ

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NAME · နာမည်

နငယ်

na-ngeh

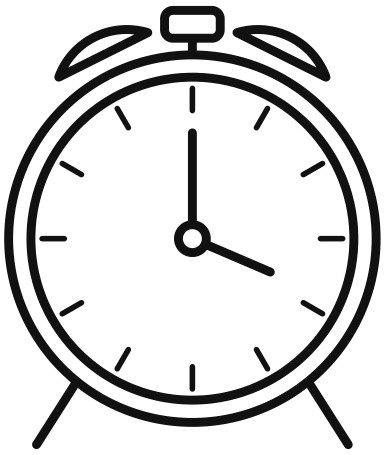
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'n' as in "net"

BURMESE PHONETICS · WITH THE SIGN ◌ာ

နာ + ◌ာ = နာ *(naa)*

Its name နငယ် means "small na".



နာ IS FOR

နာရီ

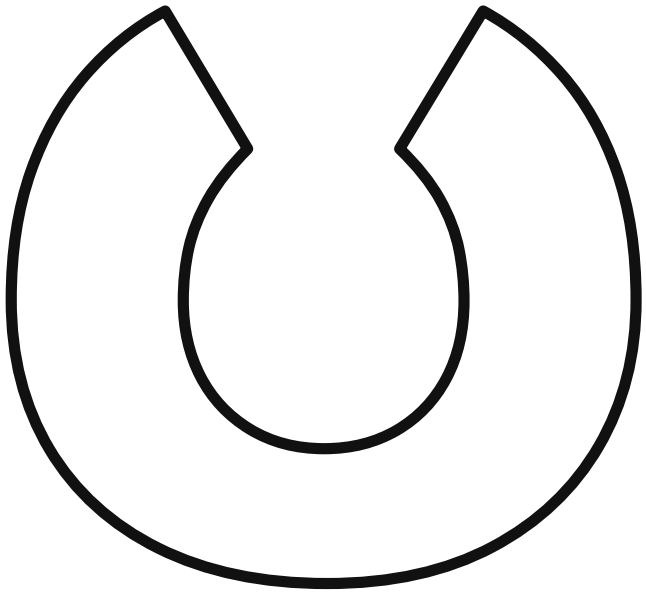
naa-yee

clock

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ရေးပါ

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NAME · နာမည်

ပစောက်

pa-zauk

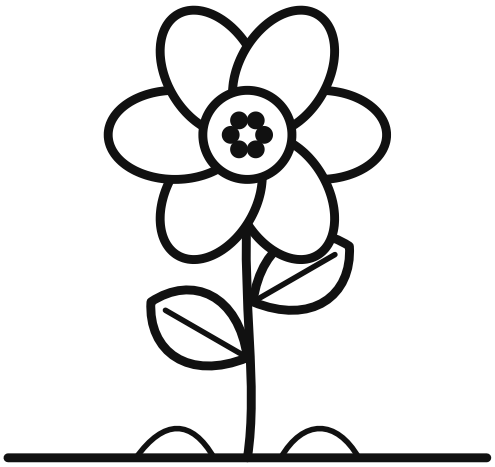
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'p' as in "spin" (no puff of air)

BURMESE PHONETICS · WITH THE SIGN ◌ာ

ပ + ◌ါ = ပါ *(paa)*

Round letters like this one take the **tall** sign ◌ါ, so they are not mixed up with another letter.



ပ IS FOR

ပန်း

pan

flower

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ရေးပါ

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ဖ

NAME · နာမည်

ဖဦးထုပ်

pha-oo-htouk

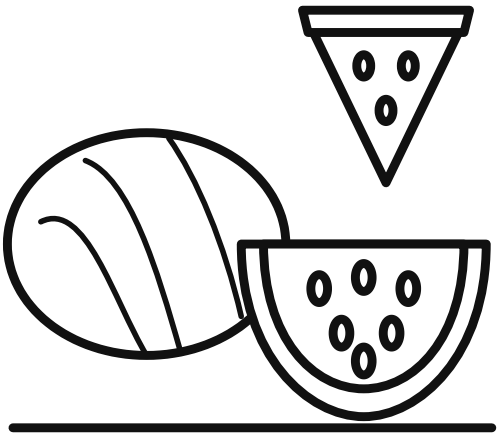
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'p' with a puff of air, as in "pen"

BURMESE PHONETICS · WITH THE SIGN ◌ာ

ဖ + ◌ာ = ဖာ *(phaa)*

Its name ဖဦးထုပ် means "pha with a hat".



ဖ IS FOR

ဖရဲသီး

pha-yeh-thee

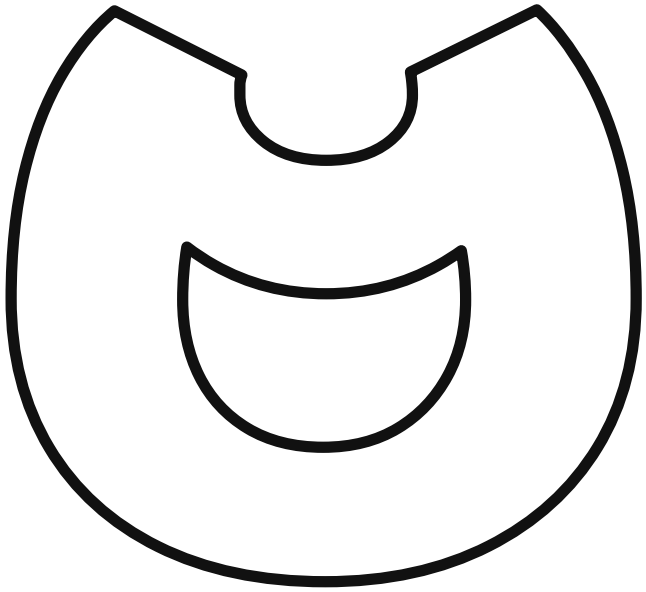
watermelon

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ရေးပါ

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NAME · နာမည်

ဗထက်ခြိုက်

ba-htet-chaik

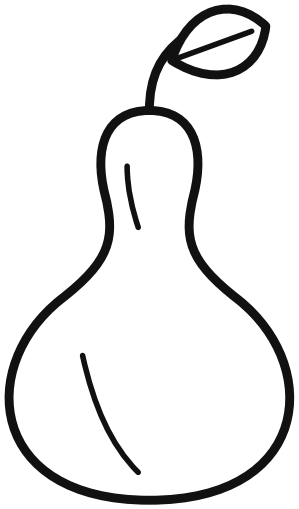
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'b' as in "ball"

BURMESE PHONETICS · WITH THE SIGN ◌ာ

ဗ + ◌ာ = ဗာ *(baa)*

Its name ဗထက်ခြိုက် means "ba with a dip on top".



ဗ IS FOR

ဗူးသီး

boo-thee

bottle gourd

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ရေးပါ

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ဘ

NAME · နာမည်

ဘကွန်း

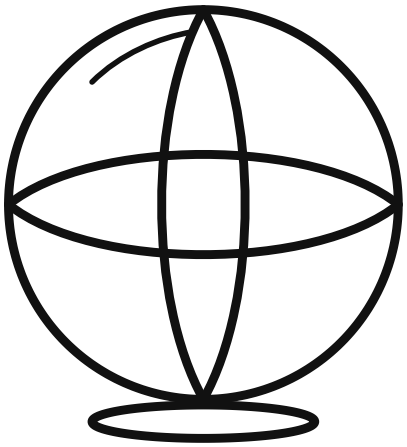
ba-goun

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'b' as in "ball"

BURMESE PHONETICS · WITH THE SIGN ◌ာ

ဘ + ◌ာ = ဘာ *(baa)*



ဘ IS FOR

ဘောလုံး

baw-loun

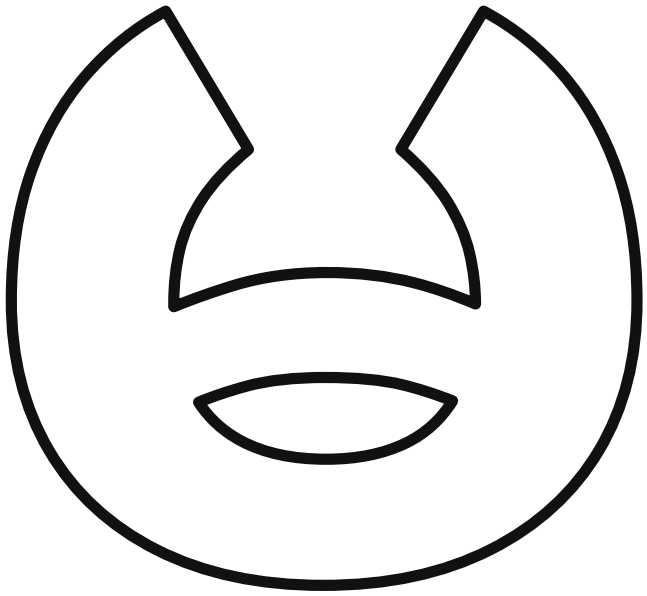
ball

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ရေးပါ

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NAME · နာမည်

မ

ma

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'm' as in "moon"

BURMESE PHONETICS · WITH THE SIGN ◌ာ

မ + ◌ာ = မာ *(maa)*



မ IS FOR

မိုး

moe

rain

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ရေးပါ

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ယ

NAME · နာမည်

ယပက်လက်

ya-pet-let

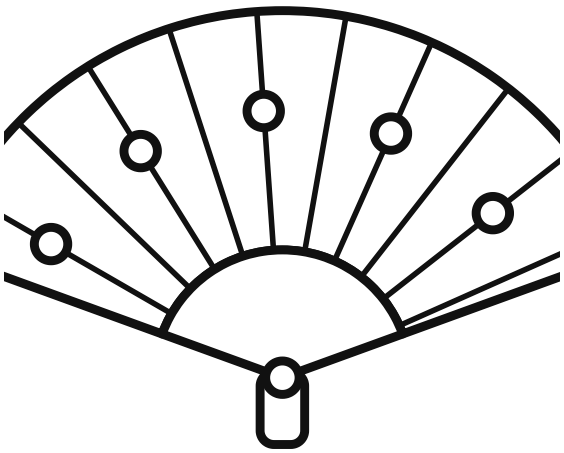
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'y' as in "yes"

BURMESE PHONETICS · WITH THE SIGN ◌ာ

ယ + ◌ာ = ယာ *(yaa)*

Its name ယပက်လက် means "ya lying on its back".



ယ IS FOR

ယပ်တောင်

yat-taung

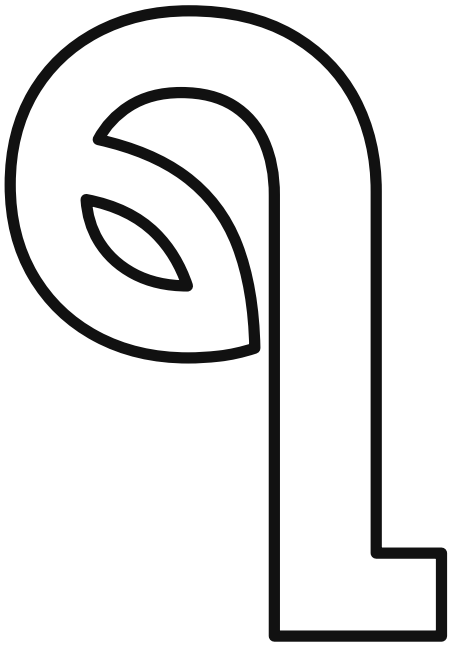
hand fan

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ရေးပါ

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NAME · နာမည်

ရကောက်

ya-gauk

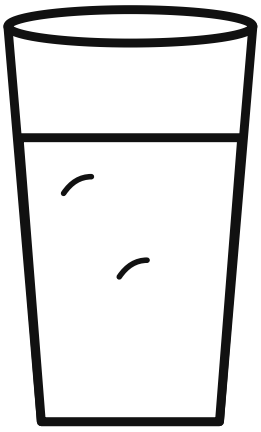
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'y' as in "yes" (in some words 'r')

BURMESE PHONETICS · WITH THE SIGN ◌ာ

ရ + ◌ာ = ရာ *(yaa)*

Its name ရကောက် means "bent ya".



ရ IS FOR

ဂရ

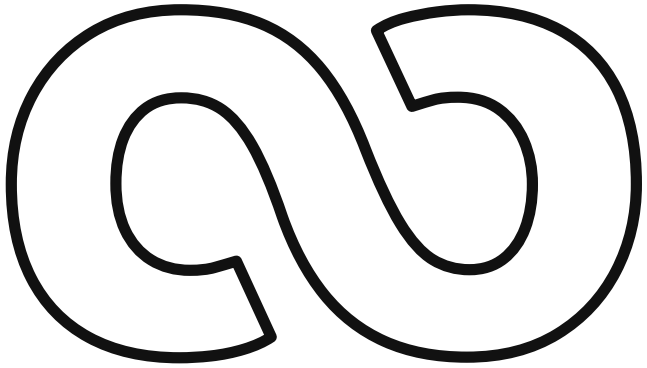
yay

water

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ရေးပါ

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NAME · နာမည်

 လ

la

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'l' as in "lamp"

BURMESE PHONETICS · WITH THE SIGN ◌ာ

လ + ◌ာ = လာ *(laa)*

လ is a whole word by itself: it means "moon" (and "month").



လ IS FOR

လ

la

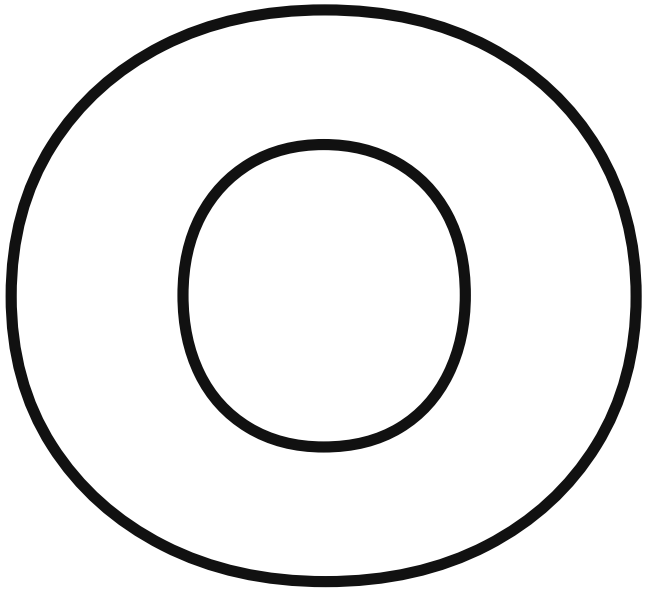
moon

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ရေးပါ

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NAME · နာမည်

ဝ

wa

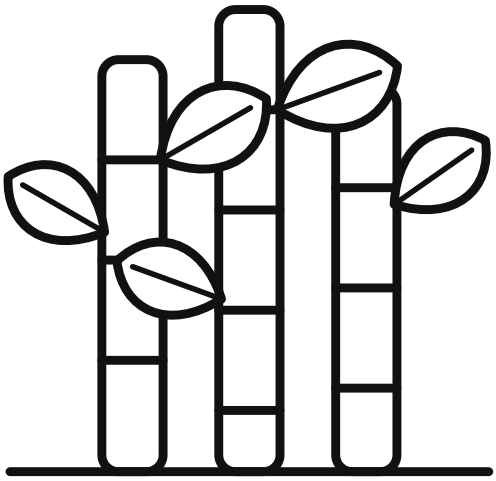
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘w’ as in “water”

BURMESE PHONETICS · WITH THE SIGN ◌ာ

ဝ + ◌ါ = ဝါ *(waa)*

Round letters like this one take the **tall** sign ◌ါ, so they are not mixed up with another letter.



ဝ IS FOR

ဝါး

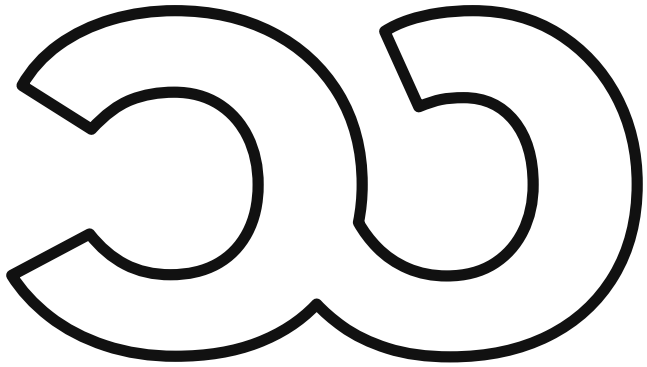
waa

bamboo

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ရေးပါ

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NAME · နာမည်

သ

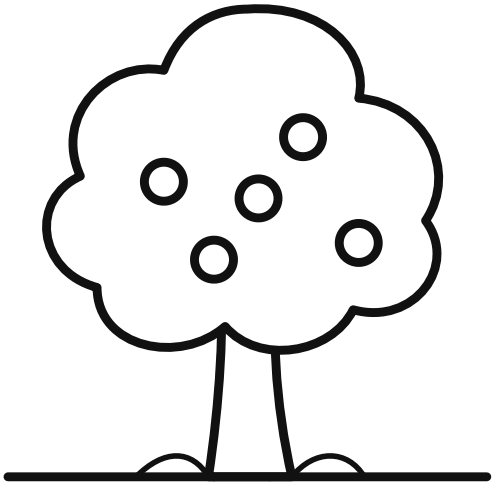
tha

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'th' as in "thin" (often softer, as in "this")

BURMESE PHONETICS · WITH THE SIGN ◌ာ

သ + ◌ာ = သာ *(thaa)*



သ IS FOR

သစ်ပင်

thit-pin

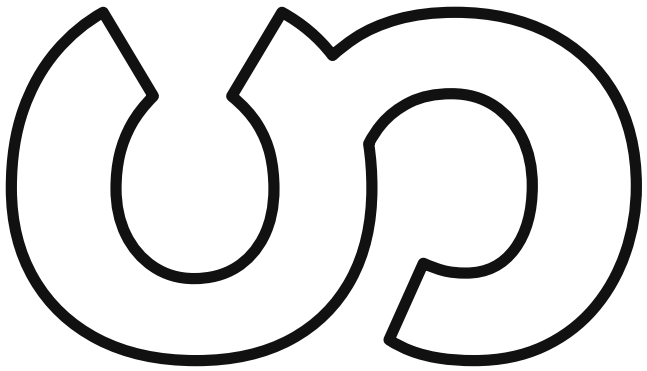
tree

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ရေးပါ

သ သ သ သ

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NAME · နာမည်

ဟ

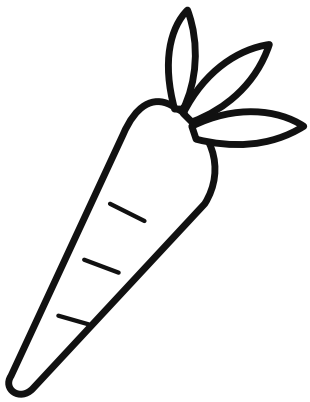
ha

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'h' as in "hat"

BURMESE PHONETICS · WITH THE SIGN ◌ာ

ဟ + ◌ာ = ဟာ *(haa)*



ဟ IS FOR

ဟင်းသီးဟင်းရွက်

hin-thee hin-ywet

vegetables

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ရေးပါ

ဟ ဟ ဟ ဟ

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ဠ

NAME · နာမည်

ဠကြီး

la-jee

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

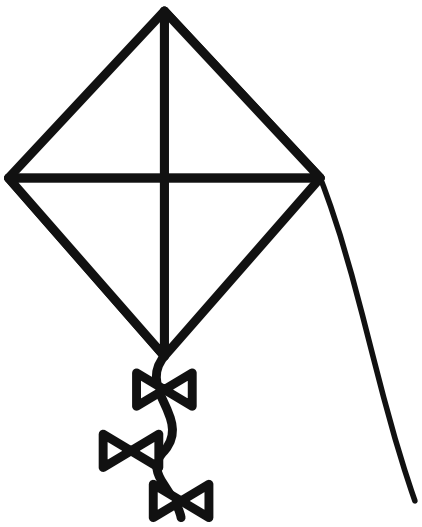
'l' as in "lamp" — a rare letter

BURMESE PHONETICS · WITH THE SIGN ◌ာ

ဠ + ◌ာ = ဠာ *(laa)*

Its name ဠကြီး means "big la".

ဠ is a rare letter, used in a few words that came from the old Pali language — find it in ကီဠာ!



ဠ IS FOR

ကီဠာ

kee-laa

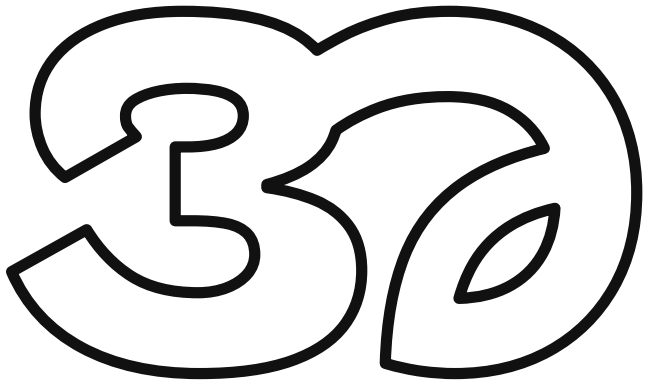
sports and games (like flying a kite!)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ရေးပါ

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NAME · နာမည်

အ

a

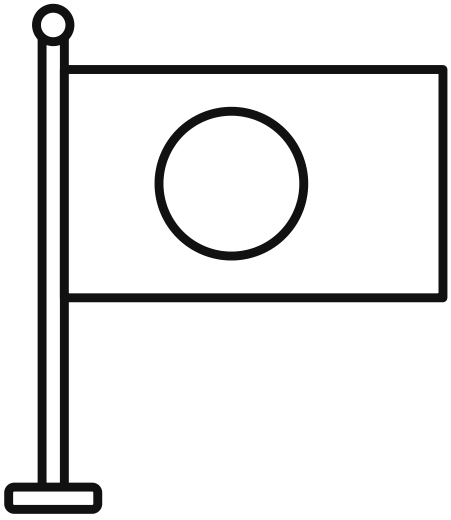
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a little catch in the throat, then ‘a’ — like the start of “uh-oh”

BURMESE PHONETICS · WITH THE SIGN ◌ာ

အ + ◌ာ = အာ *(aa)*

အ also carries the vowel signs at the start of a word: အာ အိ အီ အု…



အ IS FOR

အလံ

a-lan

flag

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ရေးပါ

အ အ အ အ

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PART 2

The Vowels သရ

tha-ra — the vowels

A vowel is written as a small **sign** around a consonant: above it, below it, before it or after it. To show a vowel on its own, Burmese writes it on the letter အ, which keeps the sign company: အ + ◌ာ = အာ *aa*. This book teaches the **11 main vowel signs**.

Before, after, above, below

◌ေ is written **before** the letter but said after it: က + ◌ေ = ကေ *kay*. ◌ိ ◌ီ ◌ံ ◌့ sit **on top**, ◌ု ◌ူ hang **below**, and ◌ာ comes **after**.

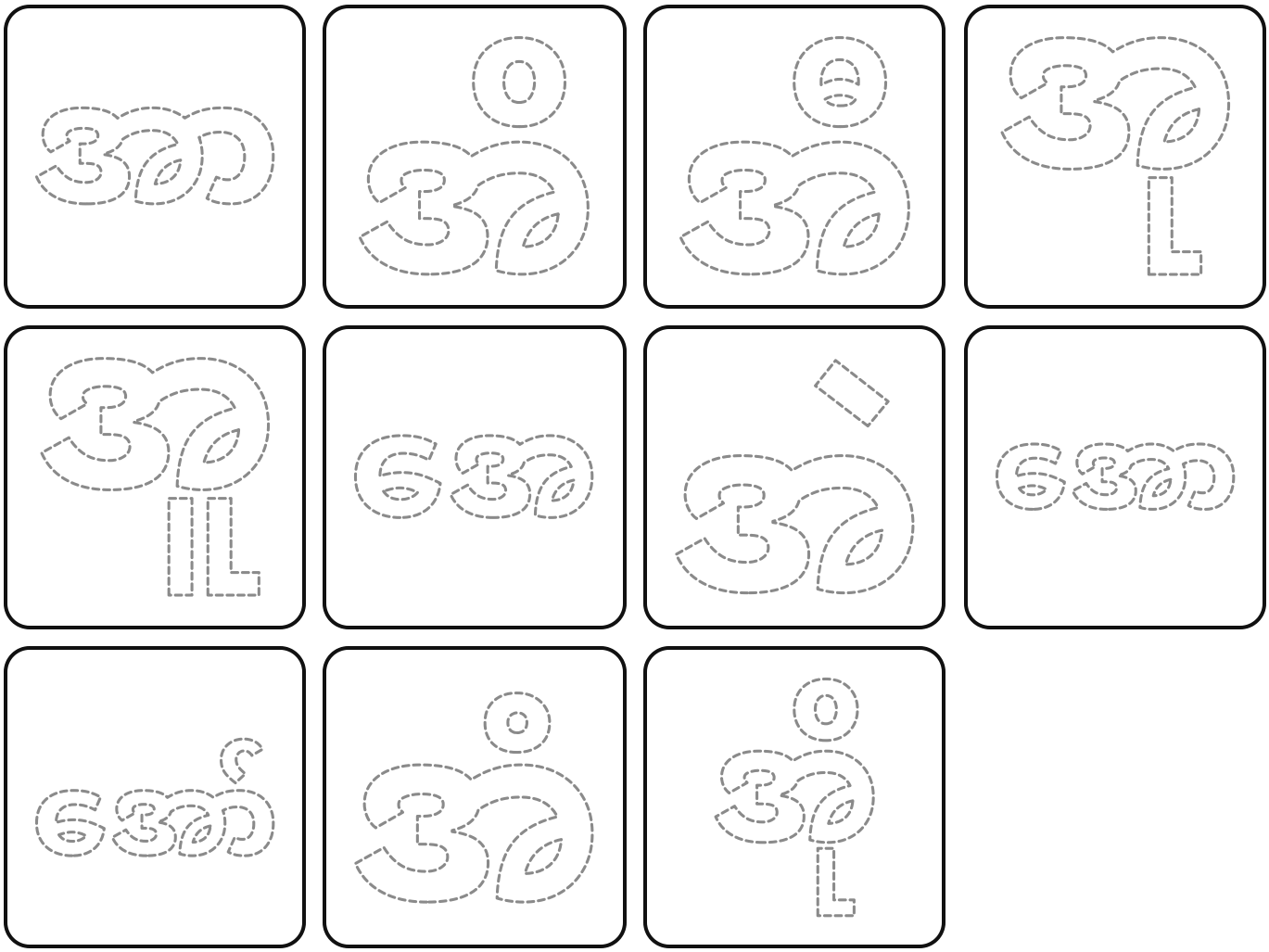
Burmese has tones

The same vowel can be said high, low or short, and that can change the meaning. Two small marks help: ◌း (a high, long sound) and ◌့ (a short, creaky sound). Listen to a Burmese speaker and copy the tune!

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the vowels ಅಆ

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.



အာ

NAME · နာမည်

အာ

aa

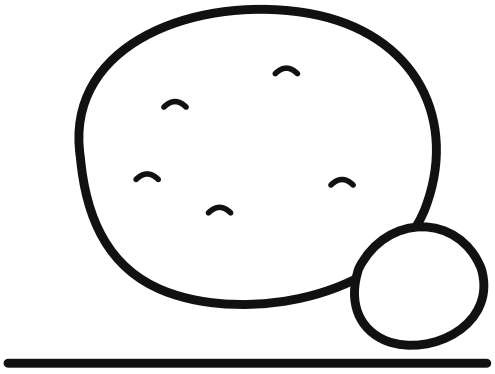
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'aa' as in "father"

BURMESE PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ာ (ရေးချ *yay-cha*)

က + ာ = ကာ



အာ IS FOR

အာလူး

aa-loo

potato

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ရေးပါ

အာ အာ အာ အာ

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အ

NAME · နာမည်

အိ

i

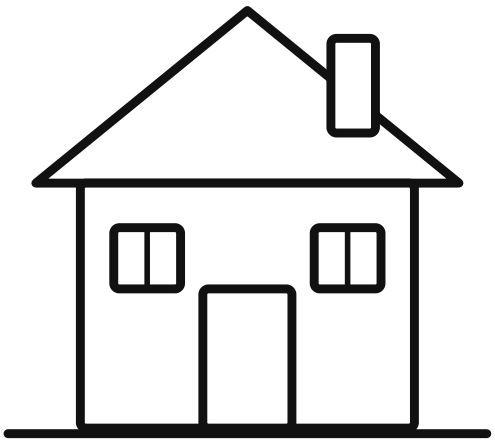
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a short ‘i’, between “sit” and “say”

BURMESE PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ိ (လုံးကြီးတင် *loun-jee-tin*)

က + ိ = ကိ



အိ IS FOR

အိမ်

ein

house

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ရေးပါ

အ အ အ အ

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အီ

NAME · နာမည်

အီ

ee

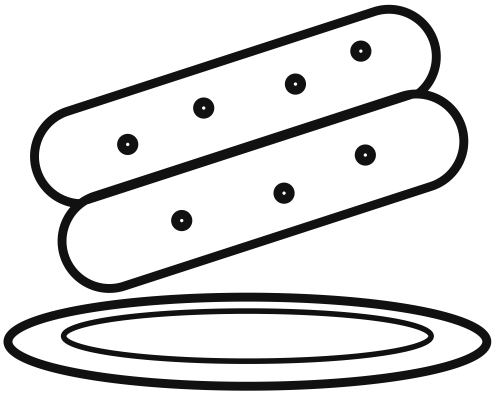
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ee’ as in “see”

BURMESE PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ီ (လုံးကြီးတင်ဆန်ခတ် *loun-jee-tin hsan-khat*)

က + ီ = ကီ



အီ IS FOR

အီကြာကွေး

ee-jaa-kway

fried dough sticks

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ရေးပါ

အီ အီ အီ အီ

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အု

NAME · နာမည်

အု

u

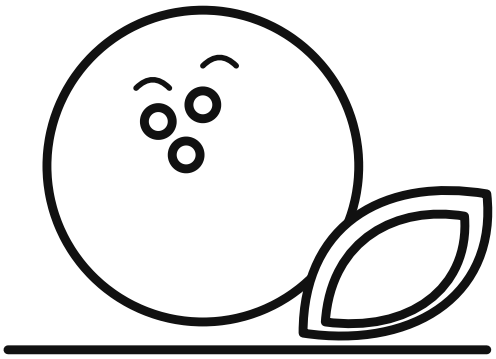
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a short ‘u’ as in “put”

BURMESE PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ု (တစ်ချောင်းငင် *ta-chaung-ngin*)

က + ု = ကု



အု IS FOR

အုန်းသီး

oun-thee

coconut

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ရေးပါ

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အိုဝ်

NAME · နာမည်

အိုဝ်

oo

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

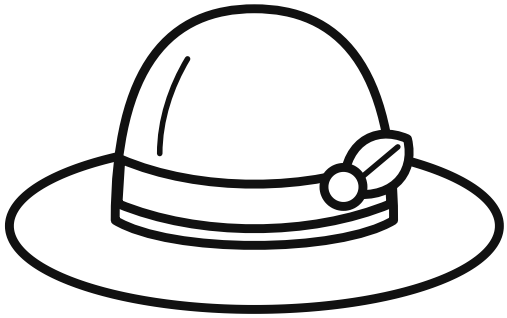
‘oo’ as in “moon”

BURMESE PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

◌ိုဝ် (နှစ်ချောင်းငင် *hna-chaung-ngin*)

က + ◌ိုဝ် = ကိုဝ်

At the start of a word this sound is usually written with its own letter, ဦ, as in ဦးထုပ်.



အိုဝ် IS FOR

ဦးထုပ်

oo-htouk

hat

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ရေးပါ

အိုဝ် အိုဝ် အိုဝ် အိုဝ်

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ေအ

NAME · နာမည်

ေအ

ay

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

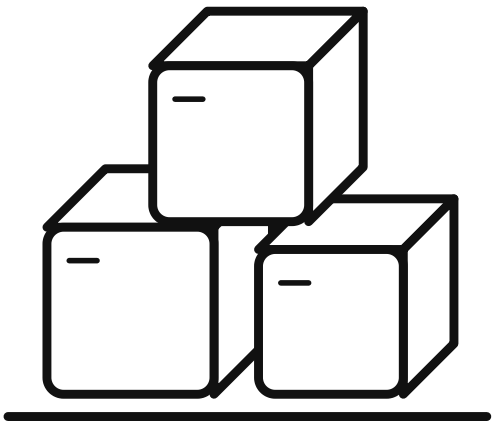
'ay' as in "day"

BURMESE PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ေ◌ (သဝေထိုး *tha-way-htoe*)

က + ေ◌ = ေက

The sign ေ◌ is written **before** the letter, but said **after** it!



ေအ IS FOR

ေအး

ay

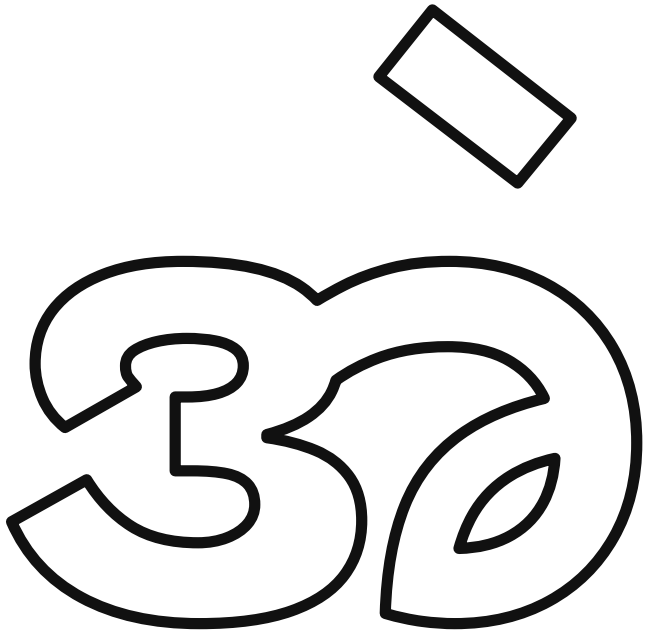
cold

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ရေးပါ

ေအ ေအ ေအ ေအ

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NAME · နာမည်

အဲ

eh

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

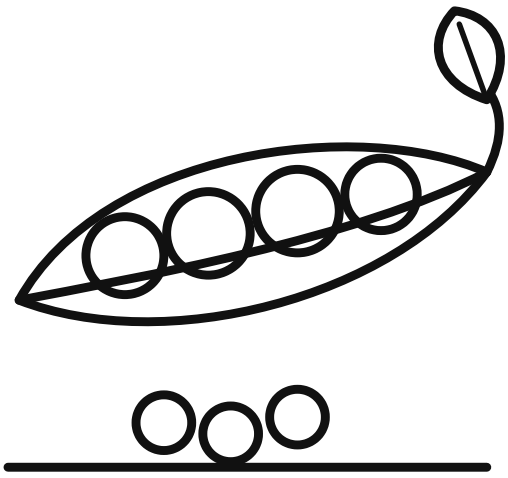
‘e’ as in “bed”

BURMESE PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ဲ (နောက်ပစ် *nauk-pyit*)

က + ဲ = ကဲ

Find the sign ဲ on top of ပ in ပဲ.



အဲ IS FOR

ဲ

peh

beans

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ရေးပါ

အဲ အဲ အဲ အဲ

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ဪ

NAME · နာမည်

ဪ

aw

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

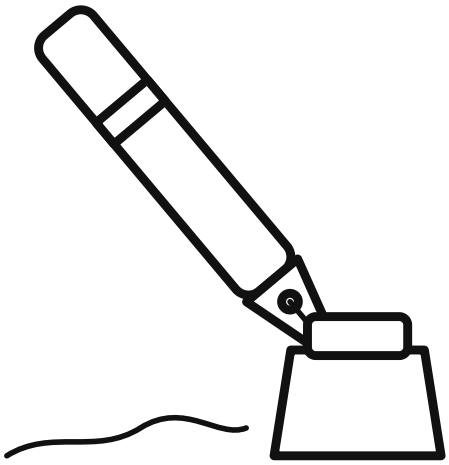
'aw' as in "saw", said short and high

BURMESE PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ော (သဝေထိုး ရေးချ *tha-way-htoe yay-cha*)

က + ော = ကော

Find ော around ဘ in ဘောပင်.



ဪ IS FOR

ဘောပင်

baw-pin

pen

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ရေးပါ

ဪ ဪ ဪ ဪ

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◌ော်

NAME · နာမည်

အော်

aw

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'aw' as in "saw", said low and long

BURMESE PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

◌ော် (သဝေထိုး ရေးချ ရှေ့ထိုး *tha-way-htoe yay-cha shay-htoe*)

က + ◌ော် = ကော်



အော် IS FOR

ကော်ဖီ

kaw-fee

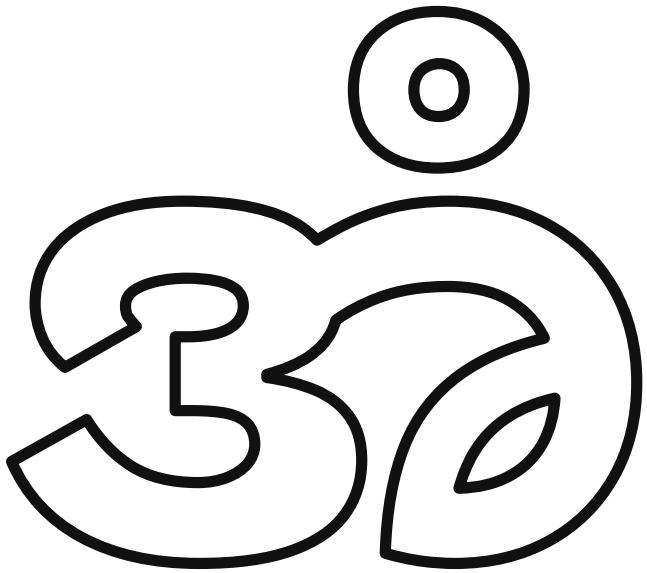
coffee

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ရေးပါ

အော် အော် အော် အော်

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NAME · နာမည်

အံ

an

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

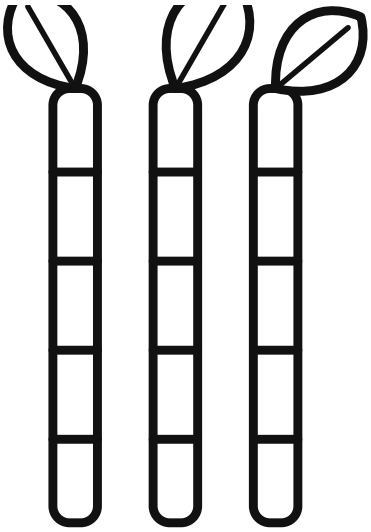
'an' — a short 'a' that ends in the nose

BURMESE PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ံ (သေးသေးတင် *thay-thay-tin*)

က + ံ = ကံ

Find the little circle ံ on top of ကံ.



အံ IS FOR

ကံ

jan

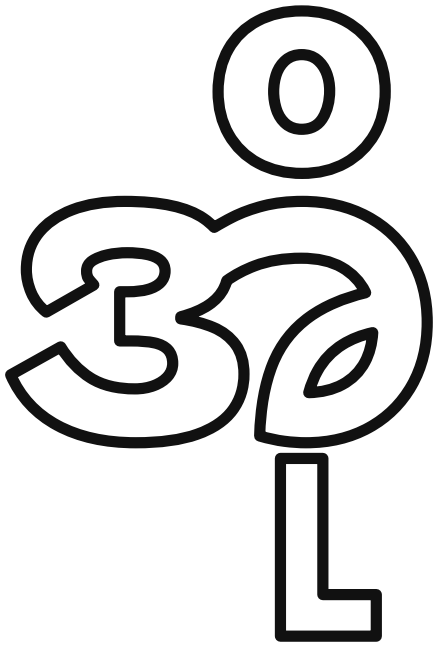
sugarcane

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ရေးပါ

အံ အံ အံ အံ

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NAME · နာမည်

အို

o

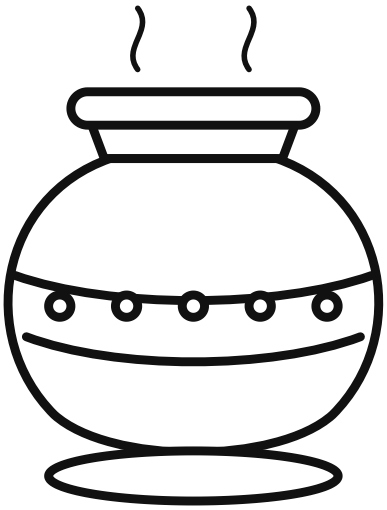
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘o’ as in “go”

BURMESE PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ိုလုံးကြီးတင် တစ်ချောင်းငင် (*loun-jee-tin ta-chaung-ngin*)

က + ိုလုံးကြီးတင် တစ်ချောင်းငင် = ကို



အို IS FOR

အိုး

oh

cooking pot

Color the picture and say the word three times!

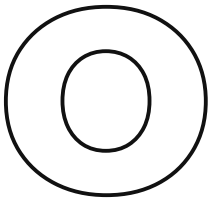
TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ရေးပါ

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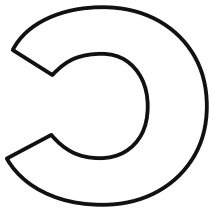
BONUS

Burmese numbers ဂဏန်း *(ga-nan)*

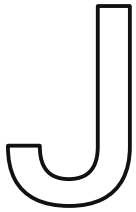
Color the numbers and count out loud in Burmese: *thoun-nya*, *tit*, *hnit*, *thoun*...



0
သုည
thoun-nya
zero



1
တစ်
tit
one



2
နှစ်
hnit
two



3
သုံး
thoun
three



4
လေး
lay
four



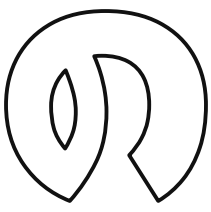
5
ငါး
ngaa
five



6
ခြောက်
chauk
six



7
ခုနစ်
khun-nit
seven



8
ရှစ်
shit
eight



9
ကိုး
koe
nine

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LET'S TALK

My first Burmese words ပထမဆုံး စကားလုံးများ

Now that you know the letters, try saying these with your family.

အဿလာမု အလိုင်ကုမ်

as-sa-laa-mu a-lai-kum
Peace be upon you (the Muslim greeting)

ဝ အလိုင်ကုမ် အဿလာမ်

wa a-lai-kum as-sa-laam
And upon you be peace (the reply)

ကျွန်တော့် နာမည် ... ပါ

ja-naw na-meh ... ba
My name is ... (a girl says: ကျွန်မ ja-ma)

ကျေးဇူးတင်ပါတယ်

jay-zoo tin-ba-deh
Thank you

ဂျဇာကလ္လာဟု ခိုင်ရန်

ja-zaa-kal-laa-hu khai-ran
May Allah reward you with good

အမေ · အဖေ

a-may · a-phay
Mother · Father

အစ်ကို · အစ်မ

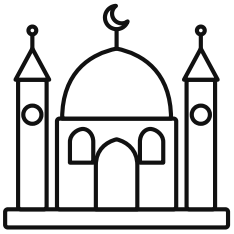
a-ko · a-ma
Brother · Sister (older)

ဟုတ်ကဲ့ · မဟုတ်ဘူး

hout-keh · ma-hout-boo
Yes · No

ကျွန်တော် မြန်မာစာ သင်နေပါတယ်!

ja-naw myan-maa-zaa thin-nay-ba-deh!
I am learning Burmese! (a girl says: ကျွန်မ ja-ma)







REFERENCES & SOURCES

Where our facts come from

[1] **The Noble Qur'an** — Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4, Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22 and Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13. Arabic text and meanings checked against **Quran.com**; the English meanings in this book are simplified for children.

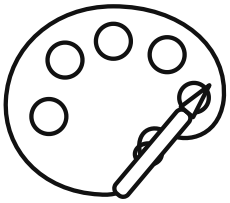
[2] **Map** — outlines from **Natural Earth** (public domain), via the *world-atlas* data set.

[3] **Language facts** — speaker numbers from **Ethnologue** (SIL International), rounded.

What's next?
You have met all **44 Burmese letters**! Keep practising by reading signs, books and food packets written in Burmese, and look out for the other books in the **Allamahul Bayan Series**, in shā' Allāh.

Enjoyed this book?
A short review on Amazon helps other families find it — *jazākumullāhu khayran!*







Certificate of Achievement

မာရှာအလ္လာဟ်! တော်လိုက်တာ!

maa-shaa-al-laa! taw-lite-taa! — Mashallah! Well done!

This certifies that

_____

has learned, traced and colored
all 44 letters of the Burmese alphabet.

Date _____ Grown-up's signature _____

Minhaz Reza

Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza, author

Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah — Publisher
An imprint of the Kunujul Akhirah Charitable Trust
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